

Z909 Plus, Wishtel Era and the Milagrow Women's TabTop. A stylus is recommended.

First up, the tablet that blew us away was the iBall Slide. We were surprised when it was fished out of the box – completely redesigned from the version that we had tested last year. It has a very slick rectangular design with 3 touch sensitive buttons – kind of inspired by the design of the Dell Streak, but only a bit bigger. The overall build quality is very good. In terms of connectivity, it supports Full USB, mini USB, mini HDMI, an SD card slot, DC in and the headphones jack. For its price, the tablet has a surprisingly premium feel to it.

The BlackBerry Playbook has the best finish we have seen on a sub 15k tablet. It has a glossy screen covering the entire front without any plastic edges. The back has a rubberized finish giving the device a very premium feel in ones hands. The connectivity options are however limited to Micro USB, charging port and mini HDMI.

The one device that stands out is the Intex iTab. Not only because it has the largest display amongst the competition but it also spots a 4:3 aspect ratio – a rarity these days.

The other tablet that sports a 4:3 aspect ratio is the Milagrow Women TabTop. Apart from

HOW WE TESTED

Benchmarks: The objective tests are a series of benchmarks that measure the performance of the tablets. These benchmarks give an objective score that judges the performance of the hardware under the hood of the device. There's also a browser-based test called PeaceKeeper.

Gaming: A tablet is also a bit of a gaming device. Some of the games that are available for tablets are graphically heavy and need some power to run smoothly. As a standard, we played quite a bit of Angry Birds Space to check for issues like screen lag, input lag, etc. There is also a benchmark, GLBenchmark (Egypt Standard) that measures the gaming capabilities of the device. In all these cases, a higher score means better performance.

Start up: Beyond benchmarks (going subjective now), we also tested the startup time of these devices to see how long it takes for the tablets to reach the lock screen from the power off mode. This was done after factory resetting the tablets, doing the logins at the first startup, and restarting

the device again. No apps were installed prior to this test, except for the ones that came pre-loaded.

Multimedia: We ran a bunch of 1080p videos in the. MP4 format. We not only judged the ability of the device to play the video smoothly – jumping forwards and backward on the play-timeline to check for stutters, freeze, crashes etc. We also played a bunch of MP3 songs to see how the speakers performed.

Build: Since a tablet is considered as a "lifestyle" device, we have also taken into consideration the build quality, plastics used, slimness of the device and its overall feel in our hands. There are multiple parameters on which each tablet is rated, before we reach one final build quality score.

Battery life: To test the longevity of the battery, we first ran a video in loop until the battery reached from 100% to 0%. Secondly, we made some real world use of the device my running apps, watching videos, listening to music, e-mail, so on and so forth, to see the life span of the battery.

lacking a full sized USB and an HDMI out, it has all the other connectivity options. The biggest downer is that the touch-screen is resistive and the device itself doesn't house the stylus, which is disappointing.

The iBerry Auxus AX02 has a rectangle clean design, some people may find the edges to be a little sharp. The build of plastic on this one is really nice. It has a black matte finish with ports neatly laid out on one side.

But the slimmest of them all has to be the Micromax

Funbook. On the face, the device looks very similar to the Mercury Mtab but is a much slimmer version of the same. The build of the device is plastic and it houses all the ports apart from a full sized USB port.

The Mercury Mtab on the other hand is one the oldest budget tablets on our list. The successor to the Mtab, the Mtab Neo2 however is a massive improvement from its predecessor. It has a very nice form factor, similar to that of the iBerry, houses all the ports and

even has a slot for a SIM card. Pair of twins that have made it on our list are the Beetel Magiq and the Beetel Magiq Glide. The Magiq is the first gen tablet from Beetel where as the Glide was launched much later. These are 2 tablets on our list that have SIM card support (works with all GSM networks – no network lock) that can be used for data as well as to make calls. The core design of both the Magiq devices is essentially the same but the Magiq has a resistive touch-screen and the Magiq Glide has

ASUS
Inspiring Innovation • Persistent Perfection

ASUS LED Monitors

The Most User-Friendly Professional Monitors

PA238Q (23" W) ML248H (24" W) ML238H (23" W)

IPS LED Color Accuracy 95% 1000000:1 Contrast 2ms Response Time 55% Energy Saving HDMI Splendid Ultra-slim 16.5mm

ASUS - No.1 in Quality and Services - The Wall Street Journal Asia

www.asus.in | Toll Free No. 1800-2090-365
SMS ASUS-LED to 567678 | For Feedback Email reachus@asus.com or Log on to www.asuservice.com